

Social Science

SPANISH GOVERNMENT

- Ferdinand Magellan discovered the Philippines on March 16, 1521 and consummated by the conquest of Miguel Lopez de Legaspi forty-five years later.
- On 1898, the Philippines was ceded by Spain to the United States by virtue of the Treaty of Paris.
- From 1565 to 1891, the Philippines was governed by the King of Spain through Mexico.
- From 1821-1837 Mexico gained its independence so the Philippines was then ruled directly by Spain through the Council of Indies.
- In 1837, legislation for the Philippines was temporarily performed by the Council of Ministries.
- The Ministry of Ultramar exercised general powers of supervision over Philippine affairs.
- Barangays were consolidated into pueblos (towns) and headed by a gobernadorcillo popularly called as Capitan and the towns into provinces headed by a Gobernador who represents the Governor-General in the province.
- In 1565, Cebu was established as the first city, followed by Manila in 1571.
- Miguel Lopez de Legaspi was the first Governor-General and the last was Gen. Diego delos Rios.

REVOLUTIONARY GOVERNMENT

- On August 26, 1896, The Katipunan which was a secret society that precipitated the Philippine revolution against Spain.
- Andres Bonifacio organized The Katipunan.
- On November 1, 1897, a republic was established by Gen. Emilio Aguinaldo in Biak-na-Bato.
- The Biak-na-Bato Republic declared the separation of the Philippines from Spain.
- On May 24, 1898, Gen. Aguinaldo established the Dictatorial Government following the outbreak of the Spanish-American war on April 25, 1898.
- The proclamation of Philippine independence was held at Kawit, Cavite in June 12, 1898.
- On June 23, 1898, Gen. Aguinaldo established the Revolutionary Government replacing the dictatorial government.
- On September 15, 1898, a revolutionary congress of Filipino representatives met in Malolos, Bulacan and framed the so-called Malolos Constitution.

- The Constitution established a free and independent Philippine Republic which was inaugurated on January 23, 1899, with Gen. Aguinaldo as President.
- In February 1899, the United States annexed the Philippines as a result of the Spanish-American War.
- In April 1901, Gen. Aguinaldo was captured.

AMERICAN GOVERNMENT

- On April 14, 1898 the American military rule in the Philippines.
- The three American Military Governors were: Gen. Wesley Meritt, Ge. Elwell Otis and the last was Gen. Arthur McArthur.
- On July 4, 1901, a civil government was inaugurated headed by a Civil Governor.
- On February 6, 1905, the title was changed to Governor-General who exercised legislative powers.
- The Philippine Commission acted as the upper house of the legislative branch with the Philippine Assembly serving as the lower house.
- In 1916, with the passage of the Jones Law, the two bodies gave way to the Philippine legislature.
- The Philippines was represented in the United States by two Resident Commissioners who were elected by the Philippine legislature.
- The first Civil Governor was Judge William H. Taft (1901-1903). Followed by Luke F. Wright (1904-1906) who was the first American to enjoy the title of Governor-General of the Philippines.
- The last Governor-General was Frank Murphy (1933-1935) who was also the first High Commissioner of the United States to the Philippines upon the inauguration of the Commonwealth government of the Philippines.
- The Commonwealth Government of the Philippines was pursuant to an act of the United States Congress on March 24, 1934, commonly known as the Tydings-McDuffie Law.
- The law provided for a transition period of ten years during which the Philippine Commonwealth would operate until July 4, 1946, wherein the independence of the Philippines would be proclaimed and established.



- The new government of the Philippines was inaugurated on November 15, 1935 following the first national election under the 1935 constitution held on September 12, 1935 with Manuel L. Quezon and Sergio Osmena as President and Vice President respectively.
- The government of the Commonwealth was autonomous in nature.
- The Commonwealth government was put to exile in Washington from May 13 1942 to October 3 1944. It was reestablished in Manila on February 27, 1945 when Douglas MacArthur turned over to President Osmena the full powers and responsibilities of the Commonwealth government under the 1935 Constitution.

JAPANESE GOVERNMENT

- On January 3, 1942 the Japanese Military Administrator was established in Manila.
- A civil government known as the Philippine Executive Commission was established with Jorge B. Vargas as its chairman.
- On October 14, 1943, the so-called Japanese sponsored Republic of the Philippines was inaugurated with Jose P. Laurel as President.
- On August 17, 1945, President Laurel dissolved the Republic.

THIRD PHILIPPINE REPUBLIC

- On July 4, 1946, the Third Philippine Republic was inaugurated when the Philippines was finally liberated from the hands of the Japanese.
- Manuel A. Roxas acted as the president and Elpidio Quirino as vice president.
- On April 16, 1948 Roxas died paving the way for the Quirino presidency which lasted until 1953.
- Quirino was followed by Ramon Magsaysay who was not able to finish his term when he died in a plane crash on March 17, 1957.
- Carlos P. Garcia followed Magsaysay.
- Garcia was followed by Diosdado Macapagal who served the country for only one term.
- Macapagal was defeated by Ferdinand Marcos in the presidential election of 1965.